

INDIANA ESPORTS NETWORK BYLAWS & GENERAL RULES



IEN
INDIANA ESPORTS
— NETWORK —

Organizational Structure

- **Mission and Purpose**

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) is a nonprofit educational esports organization of public, private, charter, and parochial schools throughout the State of Indiana. IEN exists to prepare students for an ever-evolving world by providing meaningful opportunities to develop collaboration, communication, creativity, critical thinking, leadership, sportsmanship, and digital citizenship through esports competition and related educational experiences.

- To fulfill this mission, IEN is committed to:
 - **Providing a structured and competitive esports league** for member schools and school districts, offering organized regular-season competition, postseason play, and championship opportunities that promote excellence, teamwork, and sportsmanship.
 - **Supporting the growth and sustainability of school esports programs** through guidance, resources, and best practices in program development, administration, coaching, and funding.
 - **Fostering an inclusive and welcoming community** where all students are valued, respected, and empowered to participate. IEN is dedicated to creating opportunities that are free from discrimination, harassment, and prejudice, ensuring that students of all backgrounds and abilities have access to the benefits of esports.
 - **Developing future-ready skills** by using esports as a platform for experiential learning, helping students strengthen communication, collaboration, leadership, critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving skills that contribute to success in school, careers, and life.
 - **Promoting positive community engagement and competitive integrity** through respectful conduct, responsible digital citizenship, fair play, and a commitment to the highest standards of character both in and out of competition.

- **Vision**

- The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) strives to create a positive, inclusive, and competitive esports environment that empowers students to grow as competitors, leaders, and members of their communities. Through educationally focused esports opportunities, IEN is committed to the following core values:

- **Students First**

- Students are at the center of every decision we make. Their growth, well-being, and success are the foundation of our mission and the reason our programs exist.

- **Positive Community**

- We promote and model respectful, responsible, and sportsmanlike behavior. Participants are expected to contribute to a welcoming gaming culture that reflects the highest standards of character and professionalism.

- **Inclusion and Belonging**

- Esports is for everyone. IEN is dedicated to creating opportunities where all students feel welcomed, valued, respected, and empowered to participate regardless of background or experience level.

- **Fair Play and Competitive Integrity**

- We are committed to maintaining a level playing field through clear, consistent rules and policies that uphold fairness, honesty, and integrity in competition.

- **Education and Program Development**

- IEN provides meaningful opportunities for students to learn, compete, and develop valuable life skills through esports while supporting schools in building sustainable and successful esports programs.

- **Board of Directors:**

The Board of Directors serves as the governing body and official administrative authority of the Indiana Esports Network (IEN). The Board is responsible for the oversight, development, administration, and ongoing improvement of all IEN programs, competitions, policies, and educational initiatives, including middle school, high school, unified, and community divisions.

The Board shall meet on a regular basis, no less than once per month, to conduct the business of the organization and ensure the continued growth and success of IEN programs and services.

Board members serve as volunteers and are appointed through a majority vote of the current Board of Directors. The Board is responsible for filling vacancies and maintaining a membership that reflects the mission and values of the organization.

A Board member may resign at any time by providing notice to the Board. Additionally, a Board member may be removed for cause or at the discretion of the Board through a majority vote of the remaining Board members, in accordance with the procedures established by the organization.

- **Confidentiality**

All non-public information, including but not limited to emails, support tickets, phone calls, meeting discussions, records, documents, and other communications involving the Indiana Esports Network (IEN), its Board of Directors, administrators, committees, or representatives, shall be considered confidential.

No individual may disclose, distribute, reproduce, publish, or otherwise share confidential information without the prior written authorization of the IEN Board of Directors.

Confidential information shall be used solely for purposes directly related to the administration and operation of IEN programs and activities.

Any unauthorized disclosure or misuse of confidential information may result in disciplinary action, including suspension, removal from participation, revocation of membership privileges, removal from leadership positions, or other sanctions deemed appropriate by the IEN Board of Directors.

- **Liability**

Participation in esports activities requires access to functioning equipment, software, internet connectivity, and other resources provided by participating schools or individuals. IEN does not own, manage, maintain, or guarantee the operation of equipment, networks, facilities, or technology utilized by member schools or participants.

IEN shall not be liable for interruptions, delays, forfeitures, disconnections, equipment failures, internet outages, software malfunctions, power disruptions, or other technical issues beyond its reasonable control. Participants are solely responsible for ensuring their ability to compete and meet all competition requirements.

Except as otherwise required by law, participation fees, registration fees, and other payments made to IEN are non-refundable, and participants shall not be entitled to

- **Authority of the Board**

The IEN Board of Directors reserves the authority to investigate alleged violations of these provisions and to take corrective or disciplinary action as necessary to protect the integrity, reputation, and operations of the organization. Decisions of the Board regarding confidentiality violations, participant conduct, and related disciplinary matters shall be final unless otherwise provided by an established appeals process.

- **Participant Responsibility**

Participation in any IEN-sanctioned program, event, tournament, or competition, including but not limited to the Indiana High School Esports Network (IHSEN), Indiana Middle School Esports Network (IMSEN), Unified Esports, and Community Divisions, constitutes acknowledgment and acceptance of all applicable IEN rules, policies, procedures, and decisions.

Participants, coaches, advisors, administrators, and member schools are responsible for familiarizing themselves with all governing documents and maintaining compliance throughout the duration of their participation.

Failure to understand or review published rules and policies shall not exempt any participant or member organization from enforcement actions or penalties resulting from violations.

- **Rule Amendments and Interpretation**

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) reserves the right to establish, modify, suspend, or remove competition rules, procedures, and policies as necessary to effectively administer league operations and accommodate new games, technologies, competitive formats, or unforeseen circumstances.

Rule sets for newly sanctioned titles may be amended by the IEN Board of Directors as needed to ensure fair, safe, and effective competition. Such amendments may be implemented at any time and shall take effect upon publication or notification to member schools.

Rules and policies governing existing sanctioned competitions may be amended during a season when circumstances warrant, provided the issue was not previously addressed during the preseason rules review process. Any in-season modification to an established rule set shall require approval by a majority vote of the IEN Board of Directors.

The Board of Directors shall make reasonable efforts to communicate all rule changes, clarifications, and interpretations to member schools in a timely manner. Official interpretations and rulings issued by the Board shall be considered binding and shall remain in effect until amended or rescinded.

Definitions

Participants

Term	Definition
Program Administrator/Advisor/Director	An adult staff member designated by a member school or school district to oversee its esports program. The Coach or Program Advisor serves as the school's official representative to IEN and is responsible for league communications, program administration, rule compliance, and the coordination of scrimmages and competitive activities with other member schools.
Coach	An adult staff member responsible for overseeing a member school's esports program and competitive teams. The Coach may provide player development, coordinate team activities, and serve as the Program Administrator, Program Advisor, or primary contact for league communication and scrimmage scheduling.
Staff Member	Any paid staff member or volunteer who has been approved by their member school or

	school district, has completed all required background checks and fingerprinting procedures, and is legally permitted under applicable federal, state, and local laws to supervise, coach, mentor, or otherwise interact with minor students.
Team Captain	A player appointed by their school or team to act as the team's official representative for match administration, including match setup, communication with league officials, in-game pauses, and other competition-related decisions.
Player	A student in grades 6 through 12 who meets all eligibility requirements outlined in the Player Eligibility section and participates in competitive esports on behalf of a member school or team using a computer, console, or other approved gaming platform.
Unified Athlete	An eligible student with an intellectual disability who participates as a member of a Unified Esports team and actively engages in training, practice, and competitive activities alongside Unified Partners.
Unified Partner	A student without an intellectual disability who actively participates with Unified Athletes in training, practice, and competition, fostering meaningful inclusion, teamwork, and shared competitive experiences.

Match

Official Match	A contest between two teams or participants consisting of one game or a designated series of games conducted under IEN rules and procedures for official scoring, standings, playoff qualification, or championship determination.
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Structure

Competition	Any IEN-sanctioned or member-sponsored competition in which teams consist solely of eligible students representing the same school or school district. Participants may not be rostered with players from other schools or districts unless otherwise permitted by IEN rules or approved exceptions.
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Post-Competition/Playoffs	The postseason phase of competition in which qualifying varsity teams compete in an elimination bracket to determine the IEN-sanctioned division or state champion.
Invitational Tournament	A sanctioned competition in which entry is restricted to invited teams. Invitational tournaments may be administered by IEN, IHSEN, IMSEN, or a member school and shall be conducted in accordance with rules and procedures established by the organizing body and approved by IEN where applicable.
Community Open Tournament (Open)	An IEN-sanctioned competition in which entry is available to participants who satisfy the eligibility requirements established for the event. Unlike school-based competitions, Open Tournaments may permit teams composed of players from multiple schools, organizations, or unaffiliated participants, as specified in the tournament rules and regulations.
Season	The designated period of competition for an IEN-sanctioned sport, encompassing preseason preparation, regular-season matches, and any applicable postseason or championship events. The conclusion of a season shall be determined by the approved competition format for that game.
Stage/Split	A defined competitive period within a season that contributes to cumulative standings used for postseason qualification or seeding. Upon completion of a split, member programs may reorganize, create new rosters, or discontinue teams prior to the next split, subject to applicable eligibility and roster regulations.

Penalties and Disciplinary Actions

Penalties are disciplinary measures imposed on participants, teams, schools, or school districts that violate the rules, policies, or procedures of the Indiana Esports Network (IEN), Indiana High School Esports Network (IHSEN), Indiana Middle School Esports Network (IMSEN), or Unified Esports programs.

All violations shall be reviewed and adjudicated on a case-by-case basis by designated IEN officials or representatives. Penalties shall be determined based on the nature, severity, frequency, and impact of the violation. While IEN may utilize a progressive discipline model, it reserves the right to bypass warning procedures and impose more severe sanctions when warranted by the seriousness of an offense.

Penalties may include, but are not limited to:

- Warnings or reprimands
- Match forfeitures or result overturns
- Player suspensions
- Team suspensions
- School or school district suspensions
- Player disqualifications
- Team disqualifications
- School or school district disqualifications
- Reduction, forfeiture, or revocation of awards, prizes, or other competitive benefits

Penalties are not mutually exclusive and may be imposed individually or in combination at the discretion of IEN. The severity and duration of any disciplinary action shall be determined by the circumstances of the violation and the need to preserve competitive integrity, fairness, and sportsmanship.

1st Unofficial Warning	Given to coach/sponsor of team
1st Official Warning	The league shall issue a written notice of violation to the school's coach and primary administrator. A formal warning letter may also be sent to the school's principal and superintendent outlining the violation, the applicable rule(s), and any required corrective actions.
2nd Official Warning	Team or individual will forfeit next match
3rd Official Warning	Team or individual will be banned from IEN and its affiliates for 1 Year at the discretion of IEN

Roster

Roster	The official list of players authorized to compete on behalf of a member school or school district. All rostered players must meet the eligibility standards established by their school, school district, and IEN, and must comply with all roster and participation requirements outlined in the applicable competition rules.
Starter	A player who meets all eligibility requirements and is listed in the active lineup for the beginning of a scheduled match on behalf of their school or team. Substitutions and roster changes shall be governed by the applicable game and competition rules.

Substitute	A player who meets all eligibility requirements and is listed on a team's official roster but is not part of the starting lineup. Substitute players may enter competition by replacing a starting player between rounds, maps, games, or sets, subject to the roster and substitution rules established for the applicable title and event. A varsity sub can not play in a club of the same game.
Bench Player	A player who meets all eligibility requirements and is listed on a team's official roster but is not part of the starting lineup. This is a player who can be moved up to a sub or a starting position 24 hours before the start of a match. Teams may have as many bench players as needed. Bench players may not play in a match until they are moved to either a starter or a sub position. Bench players can play at the club level of the same game. Bench players are not eligible for post-season.

Series Lengths

All matches consist of a series of individual games. The **series format** determines the maximum number of games that may be played and the number of game victories required for a team to win the match. Unless otherwise specified in the game-specific rules, match formats shall be defined as follows:

Best of 1 (Bo1)	A match format in which teams compete in a single game. The outcome of that game determines the match winner, with possible final scores of 1-0 or 0-1.
Best of 2 (Bo2)	A match format in which two games are played. A team that wins both games wins the match. If each team wins one game, the match is recorded as a tie. Possible final scores are 2-0, 1-1, or 0-2.
Best of 3 (Bo3)	A match format in which teams or players compete in a series of up to three games. The first team or player to secure two game victories wins the match. Possible final scores are 2-0, 2-1, 1-2, and 0-2.
Best of 5 (Bo5)	A match format in which players or teams compete in a series of up to five games. The first player or team to secure three game victories wins the match. Possible final scores

	are 3-0, 3-1, 3-2, 2-3, 1-3, and 0-3.
Best of 7 (Bo 7)	A match format in which players or teams compete in a series of up to seven games. The first player or team to secure four game victories wins the match. Possible final scores are 4-0, 4-1, 4-2, 4-3, 3-4, 2-4, 1-4, and 0-4.
Home/Away	A two-game match format in which each team competes once as the home team and once as the away team. Possible final scores are 2-0, 1-1, or 0-2. The home team is listed second, and the away team is listed first on all official schedules and records.

Team

Conference	A subdivision of a competitive division consisting of member schools grouped together for regular-season scheduling, standings, and competition. Conferences are generally organized by geographic region; however, conference alignment may be modified by IEN based on participation numbers, competitive balance, travel considerations, or the number of schools competing in a particular title.
Division	A competitive classification system used to group member schools according to student enrollment. Classification assignments are determined annually by the Indiana Esports Network (IEN) using the most recent enrollment data available through the National Center for Education Statistics (NCES). Classifications may be used for scheduling, standings, postseason qualification, and championship competition. Unless otherwise specified by the IEN Board of Directors, classifications shall be defined as follows: • Class 1A: Enrollment of 0–900 students • Class 2A: Enrollment of 901 or more students
Team	The official competitive unit representing a member school or school district in an

	IEN-sanctioned esports. A team consists of eligible rostered players competing in the same game title under the name of the member school or school district and in accordance with all eligibility, roster, and competition rules established by IEN. All teams must maintain a complete roster consisting of all starting players for that game and a minimum of one (1) substitute player. Teams that fail to meet the minimum roster requirement may be deemed ineligible to participate in official competition until the roster deficiency is corrected.
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Supported Game Titles and Platforms

Unless otherwise specified, all game titles offered by the Indiana Esports Network (IEN) are assumed to be played on the **Microsoft Windows PC platform**. Any alternative supported platform(s) will be identified alongside the game title in official league documentation.

The IEN Board of Directors shall review sanctioned game titles on a regular basis and may consider the addition, modification, or removal of titles based on factors including educational value, competitive integrity, participation levels, publisher support, and organizational resources.

IEN reserves the right to:

- Add new game titles to league competition at its discretion.
- Remove sanctioned game titles when deemed necessary or appropriate.
- Conduct pilot programs, exhibition events, or one-time community tournaments featuring titles not currently offered as part of the regular season.
- Modify game title offerings, competition formats, and platform requirements as necessary to support the organization's mission and operational needs.

All additions, removals, or modifications to sanctioned game titles shall be communicated to member schools through official IEN channels.

Team Title	A sanctioned esports title that utilizes a direct competition format in which two schools or school district teams face one another in an official match. Match results are used to determine standings, playoff qualification, tournament advancement, or championship outcomes in accordance with the applicable competition rules.
Solo Title	A sanctioned esports title that utilizes an individual competition format rather than a

	team-based format. Eligible students from member schools compete against participants from other schools during designated competition windows. Solo Titles exist outside the traditional varsity and club structures and are governed by title-specific registration limits and competition rules established by IEN.
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IEN Game Titles

Games currently offered by IEN:

IHSEN Titles

Title	Common Sense Media Review	Division(s)	Max Roster Size
Apex Legends (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/apex-legends	Varsity/Club	3 Starters/2 sub Club Unlimited
League of Legends	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/league-of-legends	Varsity/Club	5 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Mario Kart 8 Deluxe	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Marvel Rivals (Crossplay)	https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/	Varsity/Club	6 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Minecraft	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/minecraft	Varsity/Club	5 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Rocket League (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/rocket-league	Varsity/Club	3 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Overwatch 2 (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/overwatch-2	Varsity/Club	5 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited

Super Smash Bros. Ultimate	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Valorant	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/valorant	Varsity/Club	5 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Chess	N/A	Tournament	Unlimited
iRacing	N/A	Tournament	5 Racers
Tetris	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/tetris-0	Tournament	Unlimited

IMSEN Titles

Fortnite (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/fortnite	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Mario Kart 8 Deluxe	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Marvel Rivals (Crossplay)	https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/	Varsity/Club	6 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Minecraft	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/minecraft	Varsity/Club	5 Starters/3 Subs Club Unlimited
Rocket League (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/rocket-league	Varsity/Club	3 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Super Smash Bros. Ultimate	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Chess	N/A	Tournament	Unlimited

Tetris	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/tetris-0	Tournament	Unlimited
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Unified Titles

Rocket League (Crossplay)	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/rocket-league	Varsity/Club	3 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited
Super Smash Bros. Ultimate	https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate	Varsity/Club	4 Starters/2 Subs Club Unlimited

The list of sanctioned game titles published by IEN is subject to change and should not be considered exhaustive. Additional titles may be operated as pilot programs, exhibition events, community competitions, or local school-based activities. Individual member schools and school districts may also support esports titles that are not currently sanctioned for official IEN competition.

Varsity and Club

Varsity	A school's highest level team in a sanctioned title. Varsity teams compete for postseason qualification and the IEN State Championship. Schools may field a maximum of one Varsity Team per title. Schools with one or more Varsity Teams must pay an annual \$100 fee prior to registration. Failure to pay may result in penalties determined by the IEN Board of Directors.
Club	A team that competes below the Varsity level. Schools may field multiple Club Teams per title, but Varsity players may not compete on Club Teams in the same title. Schools may participate exclusively at the Club level. Tournament titles include postseason championship opportunities. Unless granted an exception by the Indiana Esports Network (IEN), first-year member schools must compete at the Club level for one probationary semester before becoming eligible for Varsity competition.

	A school may request an exception to this requirement if it has previously competed in another organized scholastic esports league or association. To be considered for Varsity eligibility, the school must: • Demonstrate prior competitive esports experience. • Participate in all required preseason activities and matches. • Remain in good standing with league policies and procedures. • Exhibit sportsmanship, competitive integrity, and adherence to the spirit of the game. • Meet any additional criteria established by the IEN Board. Following review of the school's participation and qualifications, the IEN Board of Directors shall vote to approve or deny the request for immediate Varsity eligibility. The decision of the Board shall be final.
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Player Eligibility

To be eligible to participate in Indiana Esports Network (IEN) competitions, all players must meet the following requirements:

Enrollment Requirements

Students must be currently enrolled in an Indiana school and meet the grade-level requirements for the applicable competition division:

- **Indiana High School Esports Network (IHSEN):** Students enrolled in grades 9-12.
- **Indiana Middle School Esports Network (IMSEN):** Students enrolled in grades 6-8.
- **Unified Esports:** Students who meet the eligibility requirements established for Unified competition.

To be eligible for participation, players must meet the following requirements:

- **Account Standing:** Players must maintain all game accounts used in competition in good standing and free from suspensions, bans, restrictions, or other disciplinary actions imposed by the game publisher or platform provider.
- **Age Requirements:** Players must meet all age requirements established by the game publisher, platform provider, and applicable laws within their jurisdiction of residence.
- **Verification of Eligibility:** All players participating in IEN-sanctioned competition may be required to provide documentation verifying their eligibility and enrollment status. Failure to provide requested documentation may result in the player, team, or school

being declared ineligible for awards, prizes, postseason participation, or other competitive benefits.

- **Public Profiles:** Players must maintain publicly viewable game profiles when permitted by the game title or platform. Public profiles allow IEN officials to verify player eligibility, account ownership, and competitive status, while also supporting opponent scouting and competitive transparency.

The IEN Board of Directors may grant eligibility exceptions on a case-by-case basis when deemed appropriate.

Code of Conduct

All players must read, understand, agree to, and sign their school's or program's Code of Conduct before participating in any IEN-sanctioned activity.

School Eligibility Requirements

All players must comply with the academic, attendance, behavioral, athletic, and esports eligibility standards established by their school or school district. Participation in IEN competition does not exempt a student from local eligibility policies.

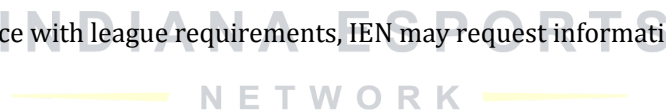
Academic and Attendance Standards

Players must meet or exceed all academic performance, attendance, and participation requirements established by their school or school district throughout the duration of the season.

Verification of Eligibility

Member schools and school districts are responsible for verifying and maintaining the eligibility of all rostered players. Upon request by IEN, schools must be able to provide documentation confirming a student's eligibility and enrollment status.

To ensure compliance with league requirements, IEN may request information including, but not limited to:



- Student's full legal name
- Date of birth
- Emergency contact information
- Proof of enrollment
- Academic or eligibility verification from the school
- Other information deemed necessary for eligibility review or competition administration

Failure to provide requested documentation within the timeframe established by IEN may result in the player's ineligibility and may subject the team or school to disciplinary action as outlined in IEN policies.

General Rules

IHSEN Team Types, Roster Rules, and Postseason Eligibility

Team Classifications

Member schools may field the following types of teams:

- **Varsity Team:** A school's highest level competitive team for a title. Schools may field a maximum of **one (1) Varsity Team** per game title.
- **Club Team:** Additional teams competing below the Varsity level. Schools may field multiple Club Teams at their discretion.

Schools may choose to participate exclusively at the Club level and are not required to field a Varsity Team.

New School Probationary Period

Schools participating in the Indiana High School Esports Network (IHSEN) for the first time shall compete at the Club level for a minimum of one (1) stage or semester before becoming eligible for Varsity competition.

A school may request an exception to this requirement if it has previously competed in another organized scholastic esports league or association. To be considered for Varsity eligibility, the school must:

- Demonstrate prior competitive esports experience.
- Participate in all required preseason activities and matches.
- Remain in good standing with league policies and procedures.
- Exhibit sportsmanship, competitive integrity, and adherence to the spirit of the game.
- Meet any additional criteria established by the IEN Board.

Following review of the school's participation and qualifications, the IEN Board of Directors shall vote to approve or deny the request for immediate Varsity eligibility. The decision of the Board shall be final.

During this probationary period, any school that accumulates more than one (1) forfeit or commits a rules violation may be required to remain at the Club level until the IEN Board of Directors determines that the program has demonstrated compliance with league policies and procedures.

Varsity Roster Eligibility

Players listed as either Starters or Substitutes on a Varsity roster are not eligible to compete in Club-level matches for the same title during that season.

A Varsity player may only participate in Club competition if they are formally removed from the Varsity roster and reassigned to Club status for the remainder of the season, subject to applicable roster deadlines and eligibility rules.

Teams participating in postseason competition may not exceed the maximum roster size established for that title.

Club Roster Eligibility

Players listed on a Club roster may participate in the next higher level of competition as permitted by league rules.

Club players may serve as substitutes for Varsity matches during the regular season. In addition, Club players may be promoted to a Varsity roster at the time of the official postseason roster lock, provided all eligibility requirements are met.

Postseason Eligibility

Only players listed on an approved and eligible postseason roster by the designated roster lock date shall be eligible to participate in postseason competition. Roster changes after the postseason roster lock shall be permitted only as outlined in the applicable competition rules or with approval from the IEN Board of Directors.

- Communication requirements, competition structure, scheduling, rescheduling, time zones, withdrawals, forfeits, equipment and software standards, match reporting, disputes, roster requirements, naming conventions, rule violations, sportsmanship, streaming and supervision requirements.

IMSEN Team Types, Roster Rules, and Postseason Eligibility

Team Classifications

Member schools may field the following types of teams:

- **Varsity Team:** A school's highest level competitive team for a particular game title. Schools may field a maximum of **one (1) Varsity Team** per title.
- **Club Team:** Additional teams competing below the Varsity level. Schools may field multiple Club Teams at the discretion of the school's program advisor or coach.

Schools may choose to participate exclusively at the Club level and are not required to field a Varsity Team.

New School Probationary Period

Schools participating in the Indiana Middle School Esports Network (IMSEN) for the first time shall compete at the Club level for a minimum of one (1) stage or semester before becoming eligible for Varsity competition.

During this probationary period, any school that accumulates more than one (1) forfeit or commits a rules violation may be required to remain at the Club level until the IEN Board of

Directors determines that the program has demonstrated compliance with league rules, policies, and procedures.

Varsity Roster Eligibility

Players listed as either Starters or Substitutes on a Varsity roster are not eligible to compete in Club-level matches for the same title during that split.

A Varsity player may only participate in Club competition if they are formally removed from the Varsity roster and reassigned to Club status for the remainder of the split, subject to applicable roster deadlines and eligibility requirements.

Teams participating in postseason competition may not exceed the maximum roster size established for the applicable title.

Club Roster Eligibility

Club players may serve as substitutes for Varsity matches during the regular season, provided they meet all eligibility requirements.

Club players may also be promoted to a Varsity roster at the time of the official postseason roster lock. Once promoted to the postseason Varsity roster, players shall be subject to all Varsity roster and eligibility requirements.

Postseason Eligibility

Only players listed on an approved postseason roster by the designated roster lock date shall be eligible to participate in postseason competition. Postseason rosters may not exceed the maximum roster size established for the title. Roster changes following the postseason roster lock shall only be permitted as authorized by the applicable competition rules or approved by the IEN Board of Directors.

Roster Locks and Player Movement

Section 1. Purpose

This section establishes requirements governing roster submissions, roster changes, player movement between competitive levels, and postseason eligibility. These rules are intended to maintain competitive integrity while providing schools with flexibility in managing their esports programs.

Section 2. Regular Season Rosters

Each school shall maintain an official roster for every team participating in an IEN-sanctioned title. Rosters must be submitted and maintained through the designated league platform or process established by IEN.

Players may be added, removed, promoted, or reassigned to another eligible team prior to the applicable roster lock date.

All rostered players must meet applicable eligibility requirements established by IEN and the player's school or school district.

Section 3. Postseason Roster Lock

IEN shall establish a postseason roster lock date prior to the start of playoff competition.

Upon the postseason roster lock:

- All postseason rosters become final.
- Players not listed on the approved postseason roster are ineligible for postseason participation.
- Teams may not add players after the postseason roster lock unless specifically authorized by IEN.
- Postseason rosters may not exceed the maximum roster size established for the title.
- Bench players are not eligible for the post-season and will not be on a roster lock.

Section 4. Player Promotion and Demotion

Promotion to Varsity

Schools may promote eligible Club players to Varsity status during the regular season, subject to roster deadlines and eligibility requirements.

Club players may also be promoted to a Varsity postseason roster before the postseason roster lock.

Demotion from Varsity

A Varsity player may be reassigned to Club status only before the applicable roster lock date.

Once a player has been demoted from Varsity to Club, that player shall remain a Club player for the remainder of the current season unless otherwise approved by IEN.

Team Transfers

Players may not compete for multiple schools during the same season unless specifically approved by the IEN Board of Directors.

Any player transferring between schools during a season may be subject to eligibility review before competing for the new school.

Section 5. Varsity Appearance Limits (IHSEN)

For Indiana High School Esports Network competition:

- Club players may substitute in Varsity matches during the regular season.

Section 6. Varsity Appearance Limits (IMSEN)

For Indiana Middle School Esports Network competition:

- Club players may substitute in Varsity matches during the regular season.
- Club players are not automatically reclassified as Varsity players based solely on the number of Varsity appearances.
- Club players may continue competing at the Club level unless officially promoted to the Varsity roster.

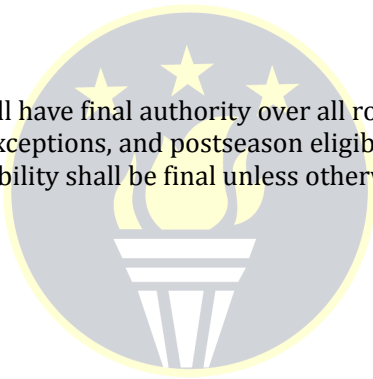
Section 7. Competitive Integrity

Roster changes made for the purpose of obtaining an unfair competitive advantage, circumventing eligibility requirements, manipulating playoff qualification, or otherwise undermining competitive integrity are prohibited.

The IEN Board of Directors reserves the right to review any roster transaction and may deny or reverse roster changes deemed contrary to the spirit of fair competition.

Section 8. Board Authority

The IEN Board of Directors shall have final authority over all roster eligibility matters, player movement disputes, waivers, exceptions, and postseason eligibility determinations. Board decisions regarding roster eligibility shall be final unless otherwise provided through an established appeals process.



General Rules

Communication

Coach and School Communication

The Coach, Program Administrator, or Program Advisor is responsible for initiating and maintaining communication with their scheduled opponents each week. Acceptable methods of communication include, but are not limited to:

- LeagueOS Match Chat (required)
- In-game or game lobby messaging

Before a forfeit win will be awarded due to an opponent's lack of response, the requesting team must provide evidence demonstrating reasonable attempts to contact the opposing team through all available communication methods.

Official IEN Communication

Discord serves as the official communication platform of the Indiana Esports Network (IEN).

All coaches, advisors, and program administrators are required to:

- IEN Website (Official)
- Email communication (Official)

- Maintain an active Discord account.
- Join the official IEN Discord server.
- Monitor official announcements and communications.
- Select appropriate roles within the designated role-selection channel to receive competition-specific announcements, updates, and notifications.

Official notices regarding league operations, schedules, events, rule changes, playoffs, and other competition matters may be distributed through the IEN Discord server.

In-Game Communication

In-game chat shall be limited to communication necessary for match administration.

Permitted uses include:

- Requesting a pause
- Reporting a technical issue
- Requesting a match restart
- Communicating administrative information approved by tournament officials

Players shall not use in-game chat for general conversation, taunting, harassment, or other non-essential communication.

Exceptions may be made during emergencies, including but not limited to:

- Fire alarms
- Severe weather warnings
- Medical emergencies
- Power outages
- Other unforeseen circumstances beyond the participants' control

Outside Communication During Matches

During an official match, players may not communicate with individuals who are not active participants in the match unless expressly permitted by the game's rules or IEN policies.

The following forms of communication remain prohibited from any person who is not an active participant in the match (including coaches, spectators, parents, teammates not in the match, or online viewers):

- Providing the real-time location of opponents (e.g., "Enemy behind you," "Two pushing B," "Sniper on the roof").
- Calling out information that the player could not reasonably know through normal gameplay.
- Relaying information obtained from spectator mode, livestreams, broadcasts, or other external viewpoints.
- Providing information from delayed streams, Discord, text messages, or other third-party communications.
- Using alternate accounts or observers to gather and relay competitive information.
- Any other communication that provides an unfair competitive advantage by revealing hidden game information.

The following types of communication are permitted:

- Designated timeouts
- Breaks between games
- Intermissions between matches
- General strategy and tactical discussions.
- Encouragement and sportsmanship.
- Time management reminders.
- Communication regarding substitutions, pauses, technical issues, or tournament procedures.
- Coaching on decision-making, teamwork, positioning principles, economy management, rotations, or other strategic concepts that do not rely on hidden information.

Communication with coaches or external parties during active gameplay is prohibited unless otherwise allowed by title-specific rules.

Competition Structure

Competition

Competition is the organized series of events, matches, and stages conducted within an IEN-sanctioned season. Different stages of competition may have unique rules governing registration, scheduling, roster management, match formats, and postseason qualification.

Preseason

Preseason, sometimes referred to as **Qualifiers**, is the stage of competition that occurs before the beginning of the regular season.

Results achieved during the preseason do not carry forward into regular-season standings unless otherwise specified in the title-specific rules.

The preseason may be used for:

- Team placement
- Qualification
- Testing competition formats
- New program onboarding
- Schedule preparation

Regular Season

The **Regular Season** is the primary competitive phase of an IEN-sanctioned season and may consist of one or more stages or splits.

During the Regular Season:

- Schools and teams compete for standings and postseason qualification.
- New teams may not enter the competition after registration closes.
- Approved roster changes may occur in accordance with IEN roster policies.

- Match results count toward standings, seeding, and postseason eligibility.

Postseason

The **Postseason**, commonly referred to as the **Playoffs**, is the championship phase of competition following the conclusion of the regular season.

The Postseason consists of a seeded single-elimination bracket featuring the highest-performing teams from the regular season.

Regular Season Standings and Seeding

Overall regular season standings shall be determined using the following metrics, in the order listed below for tie-breaking purposes:

1. **Points**
 - Each team receives **2 points** for a match win, including wins awarded through a BYE.
 - Each team receives **-2 points** for a forfeit loss.
2. **Strength of Schedule (SOS)**
 - Calculated based on the total wins earned by a team's opponents during the regular season.
3. **Match Wins**
4. **Match Losses**

These standings shall be used to determine postseason qualification and playoff seeding unless otherwise specified by the League.

The size and structure of the playoff bracket shall be determined based on factors including:

- Number of participating teams
- Division size
- Competition format
- Competitive balance considerations

Postseason rounds may include:

- Sectionals
- Regionals
- Quarterfinals
- Semifinals
- Finals
- Third-Place Match (if applicable)

Finals

The **Finals** is the final championship match of a postseason tournament in which the remaining two teams compete to determine the champion.

The winner of the Finals shall be declared the IEN Champion for that title, division, or classification.

Match Scheduling, Reschedules, Time Zones, and Forfeits

Match Start Times

Unless otherwise announced by IEN, official match start times shall be as follows:

IMSEN

- **Varsity Matches:** 3:30 PM Central / 4:30 PM Eastern
- **Club Queue:** 3:30 PM Central / 4:30 PM Eastern

IHSEN

- **Varsity Matches:** 4:00 PM Central / 5:00 PM Eastern
- **Club Queues:**
 - 3:00 PM Central / 4:00 PM Eastern
 - 4:00 PM Central / 5:00 PM Eastern

Club teams shall participate in **one (1)** designated queue during each match day.

IEN reserves the right to modify official match times as necessary and will communicate any changes through official league channels.

Match Rescheduling

Regular-season matches are expected to be played on the scheduled match date and at the designated start time.

Teams may agree to play a match at an alternate time on the same scheduled match day or up to the day before the next match is scheduled, provided both teams confirm the change in writing through LeagueOS chat prior to the originally scheduled match time.

Each team is permitted one (1) match reschedule per game title per competition week. If a team requests or requires an additional reschedule for the same game title during that competition week, the match shall be declared a forfeit against the team requesting the additional reschedule unless an exception is granted by league administration due to extraordinary circumstances.

Exceptions may be granted in circumstances including:

- School closures
- Severe weather events
- Facility issues
- Significant technical disruptions
- Other emergencies or unforeseen circumstances

Requests to reschedule must be submitted as soon as reasonably possible and may require supporting documentation.

Official Time Zones

The official time zones of the Indiana Esports Network are:

- **Eastern Time (ET)**
- **Central Time (CT)**

Unless otherwise stated, all official schedules, broadcasts, announcements, registration deadlines, and tournament information shall be published in Eastern Time with Central Time listed whenever practical.

Regional events may operate according to the time zone in which the event is conducted. Cross-region competitions involving teams from multiple time zones shall be scheduled through mutual agreement of the participating teams and in accordance with IEN policies.

Withdrawals and Forfeits

Sportsmanship Expectations

IEN expects all teams to complete the season in which they register. Coaches are encouraged to emphasize commitment, perseverance, and sportsmanship throughout the season.

Withdrawing from competition solely because of a team's record, standings, or competitive performance is considered contrary to the spirit of fair play and sportsmanship. Schools or teams found to be intentionally forfeiting matches for these reasons may be subject to disciplinary action.

Team Withdrawals

Teams choosing to withdraw from a league, tournament, or season after competition has begun may not re-enter that competition during the same season or split.

Upon withdrawal:

- All previously completed match results shall remain official.
- Remaining scheduled matches shall be recorded as forfeits.
- Opposing teams shall receive wins for all forfeited matches.
- Additional sanctions may be imposed at the discretion of the IEN Board of Directors.

Definition of a Forfeit

A forfeit occurs when a team is unable or unwilling to participate in a scheduled match.

Examples of forfeits include, but are not limited to:

- Failure to appear for a scheduled match and be prepared to begin competition within ten (10) minutes of the scheduled match start time shall receive a match forfeit.
- Insufficient eligible players to begin or complete a match
- Failure to respond to scheduling communications
- Administrative or logistical errors resulting in an inability to compete
- Other circumstances deemed by IEN to prevent participation

Forfeit rulings may be appealed to IEN for review when exceptional circumstances exist.

Consequences of Forfeits

Varsity Competition

A Varsity Team that accumulates **Three (3) or more forfeits during a season** may lose Varsity eligibility in that game title for the following season.

The affected school may be required to compete at the Club level before regaining Varsity eligibility, as determined by the IEN Board of Directors.

Annual Varsity Participation Fees are non-refundable and will not be returned as a result of forfeiture-related penalties or loss of eligibility.

Club Competition

A Club Team that accumulates **Two (2) or more forfeits during a season** shall be required to participate in a meeting with representatives of the IEN Board of Directors before being permitted to continue competing.

The Board may impose additional requirements or restrictions if continued participation is determined to be detrimental to league operations or competitive integrity.

Board Authority

The IEN Board of Directors retains final authority over all scheduling disputes, reschedule requests, forfeits, withdrawals, and related disciplinary actions. The Board may issue penalties, grant exceptions, or modify rulings when necessary to preserve fairness, competitive integrity, and the best interests of the league.

Equipment, Software, and Technical Requirements

Equipment

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) does not provide equipment, peripherals, software, or internet access for online regular-season, playoff, or championship competition. Participating schools and players are responsible for supplying and maintaining all equipment necessary for competition.

Controllers

Controllers used during official competition must be officially licensed for the platform on which they are being used unless otherwise approved by IEN. Accessibility devices and adaptive controllers are permitted when used for their intended accessibility purposes.

Controllers may not be modified in a manner that provides a competitive advantage. The use of macro functions, turbo buttons, rapid-fire functions, scripted inputs, or similar automated features is prohibited.

For fighting game titles, standard arcade sticks, fight sticks, hitbox-style controllers, and other commonly accepted competitive controllers are permitted unless restricted by game-specific rules.

Controllers may be used in PC-based competition provided that:

- The game includes native controller support.
- Only manufacturer-provided software or drivers are used.
- No third-party software is required to emulate, remap, automate, or alter controller inputs.

Drivers and Peripheral Software

Official software and drivers provided by the manufacturer for peripherals, including mice, keyboards, headsets, controllers, and other input devices, are permitted.

Software that modifies, automates, remaps, scripts, or otherwise alters player inputs is prohibited unless explicitly approved by IEN. The use of unauthorized third-party software may be considered a competitive integrity violation and subject to disciplinary action.

Approved Third-Party Utilities

Unless otherwise prohibited by a game's publisher or competition rules, the following utilities are approved for use:

- Raw Accel
- BakkesMod

IEN reserves the right to modify the list of approved utilities at any time.

Fair Connection Rule

IEN is not responsible for internet connectivity issues, network instability, hardware failures, or other technical problems experienced by players or teams.

Prior to the start of a match, participating teams are expected to agree upon a server location that provides the most equitable playing experience for all competitors.

The following guidelines shall apply:

- Packet loss, choke, or other internet quality issues are not, by themselves, sufficient grounds to require a server change.
- If a significant disparity in latency exists, either team may request a server change or match restart within the first five (5) minutes of play.
- Teams should make reasonable efforts to identify a mutually acceptable server location.
- If no agreement can be reached, the home team shall select the server location that is geographically closest to its school or players, unless otherwise specified by game-specific rules.

The final determination regarding connection disputes may be made by IEN officials when necessary.

Game Modifications

Players may not use any unauthorized modification, customization, or enhancement that alters the intended appearance, functionality, or gameplay experience of a title.

Prohibited modifications include, but are not limited to:

- Third-party skins or character models
- Custom sprites
- Custom graphical user interfaces (GUIs)
- Third-party sound packs
- Modified textures
- Third-party crosshairs
- Other visual or audio modifications not provided by the game publisher

Only content provided through official in-game systems may be used.

Certain publisher-approved cosmetic items may nevertheless be restricted by title-specific rules and may be prohibited during official competition.

Crosshairs may only be modified using settings available within the game itself.

Monitors or display devices that provide built-in crosshair overlays or similar aiming assistance features may not be used during official matches.

Overlays, Coaching Tools, and External Assistance

Unless provided directly by the game, tournament platform, or approved broadcast software, third-party overlays are prohibited during official competition.

Players may not use external tools, websites, applications, or services that provide real-time competitive assistance during a match, including but not limited to:

- Pick and ban assistance tools
- Strategy recommendation tools
- Build, loadout, or draft advisors
- Real-time analytics programs
- Match assistance software
- AI-assisted gameplay tools

The use of any external resource that provides competitive information not normally available within the game may be considered coaching, competitive assistance, or cheating and may result in disciplinary action.

IEN reserves the right to review any software, hardware, or peripheral configuration and determine its eligibility for competition. If a device, utility, or modification is determined to provide an unfair competitive advantage, IEN may prohibit its use at any time.

Match Results and Reporting

The winning team is responsible for reporting match results as soon as reasonably possible following the completion of a match. Teams are strongly encouraged to retain screenshots, match reports, game logs, or other evidence of match results in the event verification is required by IEN.

All match reports must include the final match score and any additional information required by the designated reporting platform or competition administrator.

Unless otherwise directed by IEN, match results must be submitted no later than **24 hours after the local time on the scheduled match day**. Failure to report match results by the reporting deadline may result in penalties, including the assignment of a loss to one or both teams.

For matches that have been officially rescheduled and approved by IEN, results must be reported immediately upon completion of the match.

Verification of Results

IEN reserves the right to request supporting documentation to verify any reported result. Teams that are unable to provide reasonable proof of a disputed result may be subject to administrative review and possible disciplinary action.

Failure to Report Results

Failure to submit match results by the established deadline may result in:

- A loss being recorded for both teams;
- Match results being overturned or nullified;
- Additional penalties as determined by IEN officials.

The IEN Board of Directors shall have final authority regarding disputed results, late submissions, and the enforcement of reporting requirements.

Incorrect Match Results

The accurate reporting of match results is essential to maintaining competitive integrity. Intentionally submitting false, misleading, or inaccurate match results shall be considered cheating and may result in disciplinary action.

If a team inadvertently submits an incorrect result, the team's coach, captain, or designated representative must immediately notify an IEN administrator, Tournament Organizer, or member of the Board of Directors so that the error can be reviewed and corrected.

Failure to report a known scoring error in a timely manner may result in penalties at the discretion of IEN.

Match Disputes

Teams may submit a match dispute when they believe a rule violation, scoring error, eligibility concern, technical issue, or other circumstance has affected the outcome or administration of a match.

Match disputes must be submitted before the beginning of the next scheduled week of competition. Once a new competition week has begun, disputes regarding matches from previous weeks will generally not be considered unless exceptional circumstances exist and are approved by the IEN Board of Directors.

A dispute may only involve the current competition round and may not be used to challenge results from prior rounds that have already been finalized.

Evidence Requirements

Teams filing a dispute must provide sufficient, unaltered evidence to support their claim. Acceptable evidence may include, but is not limited to:

- Screenshots
- Match recordings
- Broadcast recordings
- Video-on-Demand (VOD) footage
- Official game logs
- Platform-generated match reports
- Other relevant documentation requested by IEN officials

Failure to provide adequate evidence may result in the dispute being denied.

Submission Process

Match disputes must be submitted through the designated competition platform or directly to an IEN Board Member, Tournament Organizer, or other authorized league official.

All parties involved in a dispute are expected to cooperate fully with the investigation process and provide requested information in a timely manner.

Final Authority

IEN reserves the right to investigate, review evidence, request additional documentation, and render a final decision regarding any match dispute. The determination of the IEN Board of Directors or its designated representatives shall be final unless otherwise provided through an established appeals process.

Roster Requirements

Team Rosters

All team rosters must be submitted and maintained through the official IEN competition platform, **LeagueOS**.

Teams must maintain the minimum number of eligible players required for their respective game title. If a team's roster falls below the required minimum, the school or school district may be required to withdraw that team from competition unless an exception is approved by IEN administration. Varsity teams must have a minimum of 1 substitute per team.

Teams may not exceed the maximum roster size established in the game-specific rules for the title in which they compete.

LeagueOS Game Connections

To ensure accurate match reporting, statistics, and player verification:

- **IHSN Varsity players** are required to maintain active and current game account connections within LeagueOS.
- **IHSN Club, IMSEN Varsity, IMSEN Club, and IUEN players** are encouraged, but not required, to maintain game account connections within LeagueOS unless otherwise specified by IEN.

Failure to maintain required account connections may impact a player's eligibility, statistics tracking, or participation in certain competitions.

Naming Conventions

Player and team names are considered official identifiers for league operations and shall remain consistent throughout the season.

Player names and team names may not be changed during an active season without approval from IEN administration. IEN reserves the right to require name changes if a submitted name violates league policies or naming standards.

Individual Player Names

Player usernames, gamertags, and display names:

- Must be appropriate for a school-sponsored activity.
- May not contain vulgar, offensive, obscene, discriminatory, or otherwise inappropriate language.
- May not impersonate another person, school, organization, or participant.
- May not include personally identifiable information, except where required by the specific game title (e.g., iRacing).

IEN reserves the right to require a player to modify an account name that is deemed inappropriate or inconsistent with league standards.

Team Names

Team names shall clearly identify the participating school and competition level whenever practical.

Unless otherwise approved by IEN, team names should include:

- School name or abbreviation
- Game title abbreviation
- Level of competition

Example:

[MCHS] SSBU Varsity

Additional examples:

[PNHS] Rocket League Club

[LHS] Valorant Varsity

[CHS] Overwatch 2 Club

IEN reserves the right to modify, reject, or require changes to team names that are misleading, inappropriate, duplicate another team's identity, or otherwise inconsistent with league standards.

Rule Violations and Competitive Conduct

Rule Violations

All participants are expected to comply with the rules, policies, and procedures outlined in this handbook, as well as any applicable game-specific rules. Violations of these rules may be considered unsportsmanlike conduct and may result in disciplinary action.

While IEN generally follows a progressive discipline model, the severity of a violation may warrant skipping one or more steps at the discretion of IEN officials or the Board of Directors.

Possible disciplinary actions include:

1. **Unofficial Warning**

A private warning issued to the team's captain, coach, advisor, or program administrator regarding a minor infraction.

2. **Official Warning**

A formal warning issued by IEN. The coach, advisor, or program administrator may be required to participate in a meeting with IEN officials to review the violation and corrective actions.

3. **Competitive Penalty**

A player, team, or school may be required to forfeit a game, match, or other competitive result due to repeated or significant violations.

4. **Suspension or Removal**

Severe or repeated violations may result in suspension or removal from IEN competition. Participants, teams, or schools may be declared ineligible for a period determined by the IEN Board of Directors, including bans of up to one (1) year or more in serious cases.

The IEN Board of Directors reserves the right to impose additional penalties when necessary to protect competitive integrity and participant safety.

Match Fixing

Match Fixing is the act of intentionally influencing, manipulating, or predetermining the outcome of a match or competition before it is played.

Match fixing is strictly prohibited and represents a severe violation of competitive integrity.

Any player, coach, advisor, school representative, or other participant found to have engaged in match fixing may be subject to disciplinary action, including immediate suspension, forfeiture of results, disqualification from competition, and a minimum suspension of one (1) season.

Additional penalties may be imposed at the discretion of the IEN Board of Directors.

Sportsmanship

All participants are expected to demonstrate good sportsmanship, respect, and professionalism during IEN-sanctioned activities.

Unsportsmanlike conduct may include, but is not limited to:

- Harassment or bullying
- Excessive toxicity or abusive language
- Disrespect toward opponents, officials, spectators, or staff
- Intentional disruption of competition
- Failure to comply with official instructions
- Conduct that reflects negatively on the participant, school, or league

Participants who fail to uphold these standards may be subject to disciplinary action as determined by IEN officials.

Tainted Accounts

Players are responsible for ensuring that all accounts used during competition remain in good standing with the game's publisher and platform provider.

If a player's account receives a suspension, ban, restriction, or other disciplinary action from the game publisher or platform provider during an official match due to a violation of that platform's Terms of Service, Code of Conduct, or similar policy, IEN may impose competitive penalties.

Potential penalties may include:

- Match forfeiture
- Player suspension
- Team penalties
- Additional disciplinary action deemed appropriate by IEN

IEN reserves the right to investigate each situation individually and determine the appropriate outcome based upon the circumstances of the violation.

Spectating and Streaming

In-Game Spectators

Spectators may only be present during an official match when all of the following conditions are met:

- The spectator is viewing only their team's perspective or designated observer view.
- The spectator is a coach, approved staff member, rostered substitute, or authorized broadcast producer.
- The spectator does not communicate competitive information to any participant during active gameplay.

Unauthorized spectating may be considered a competitive integrity violation.

Neutral Observer Streaming

Certain titles, including but not limited to **Overwatch 2** and **VALORANT**, allow neutral observer or spectator perspectives.

Programs wishing to broadcast matches from a neutral observer perspective must obtain approval through the designated [IEN Verified Streaming Application](#) process.

Only [approved programs and individuals](#) may utilize neutral observer access during official matches.

Communication Restrictions

Spectators, stream producers, substitutes, coaches, and other non-participating individuals may not provide strategic information, coaching, scouting information, or other competitive assistance to active players during gameplay unless expressly permitted by title-specific rules.

Board Authority

IEN reserves the right to restrict, limit, or prohibit spectators, observers, streams, broadcasts, or recording activities at any time if doing so is necessary to preserve competitive integrity, player safety, privacy, or the orderly conduct of competition.

Game-specific rules may establish additional streaming, spectating, or broadcast requirements. When a conflict exists, the game-specific rules shall take precedence over these general provisions.

Supervision of Matches

All official Indiana Esports Network (IEN) matches must be supervised by at least one (1) approved adult representative from each participating team. This individual may serve as the team's **Program Administrator, Program Advisor, or Coach**.

The supervising representative is responsible for:

- Ensuring all participating players are eligible and properly rostered.
- Monitoring matches for potential cheating, competitive integrity violations, or unauthorized roster changes.
- Enforcing school and IEN conduct expectations during competition.
- Addressing inappropriate behavior, including vulgar language, harassment, toxicity, or unsportsmanlike conduct, in accordance with the applicable Code of Conduct.
- Serving as the primary point of contact for match-related communication and issue resolution.

Program Administrators, Program Advisors, and Coaches from both teams are expected to remain available throughout the duration of the match to address scheduling concerns, technical issues, disputes, or other competition-related matters.

Play From Home Policy

The preferred competition environment for all IEN-sanctioned matches is a school-authorized facility under adult supervision.

Students may participate remotely only under the following circumstances:

- The school operates as a fully online institution.
- The school's esports facility is under construction or development.

- The school's esports facility is temporarily unavailable due to renovation, maintenance, or other facility-related issues.
- An individual player has experienced a personal emergency or hardship that prevents on-site participation.
- Other circumstances approved by IEN administration.

In situations not specifically listed above, teams are encouraged to reschedule matches within the approved competition window so that play may occur from the school's designated esports facility.

Failure to comply with approved participation requirements may result in forfeiture or other penalties as determined by IEN.

Student Equipment and Connectivity

Students participating from home are responsible for ensuring they have access to the equipment, software, and internet connectivity necessary to compete.

Schools may provide loaned equipment to support student participation when appropriate.

Schools may not require students to personally purchase equipment in order to participate in IEN competition.

If a school is closed due to emergencies, public health concerns, or other circumstances beyond its control, students shall not be required to report to campus solely for competition purposes.

Coach Communication Requirements

Coaches, Advisors, and Program Administrators are expected to maintain active communication with their opposing counterpart throughout competition.

At a minimum, coaches must be available through real-time text communication using an approved platform such as:

- LeagueOS Match Chat
- Discord
- Email
- Other approved communication methods

Prompt communication helps resolve technical issues, scheduling concerns, roster questions, and match disputes efficiently.

All communications between coaches shall be professional, respectful, and consistent with the sportsmanship standards of IEN.

Match Start Times

Matches shall begin at the official start time established by IEN unless both teams mutually agree to an alternate start time in advance.

Any agreed-upon schedule adjustment must comply with IEN scheduling and rescheduling policies.

Teams are expected to make reasonable efforts to begin competition on time and avoid unnecessary delays.

Coach Presence During Competition

Coaches must remain accessible to their team throughout the duration of an official match.

Where game functionality permits spectating or observer access, coaches may observe only from their team's designated side, perspective, or approved observer position.

Coaches may not:

- Observe from an opponent's perspective.
- Access information unavailable to their team.
- Provide information gained through unauthorized spectating.
- Use observer tools in a manner that creates a competitive advantage.

Unauthorized spectating is considered a competitive integrity violation and may result in disciplinary action against the coach, team, and/or school.

Competitive Integrity

IEN reserves the right to investigate any supervision, communication, coaching, or spectating practice that may compromise competitive integrity.

Violations of these provisions may result in warnings, forfeitures, suspensions, disqualifications, or other sanctions as determined by the IEN Board of Directors.

In-Person Hardware and Equipment Requirements

For official IEN in-person events, including postseason, championship, and other sanctioned competitions, any title that supports multiple platforms shall be played on **Windows PC** unless otherwise specified by IEN.

Players are responsible for ensuring they can successfully access, authenticate, and compete using the game account associated with their official competition profile and regular-season participation. All required accounts must be in good standing and linked to the appropriate competition platform when applicable.

IEN may provide basic competition equipment and peripherals, including computers, keyboards, mice, monitors, and headsets, when available. However, the availability of provided equipment is not guaranteed.

Coaches, advisors, and schools are responsible for ensuring that their players have access to any required equipment, peripherals, controllers, adapters, accessibility devices, or other approved hardware necessary for competition. All equipment used during official competition must comply with the requirements outlined in the **Equipment, Software, and Technical Requirements** section of this handbook.

Players who are unable to successfully authenticate their accounts, utilize the required hardware, or meet the technical requirements for competition may be subject to delays, substitutions, forfeiture, or other administrative actions as determined by tournament officials.

IEN reserves the right to inspect, approve, or prohibit any equipment, peripheral, or software used during in-person competition to ensure compliance with league rules and preserve competitive integrity.

IEN Game Rulesets

	IHSEN & IMSEN Chess Rules
	IMSEN Fortnite Rules
	IHSEN iRacing Rules
	ESPORTS FOR IHSEN League of Legends Rules
	IHSEN & IMSEN Mario Kart Rules

	IHSEN & IMSEN Marvel Rivals Rules
	IHSEN & IMSEN Minecraft Rules
	IHSEN Overwatch 2 Rules
	IHSEN & IMSEN Rocket League Rules
	IHSEN & IMSEN SSBU Rules

	IHSEN & IMSEN Tetris Rules
	Unified Rocket League Rules
	Unified SSBU Rules
	IHSEN Valorant Rules
	Apex Legends Rules

Rule Amendments and Interpretations

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) reserves the right to interpret, amend, modify, suspend, or create rules, policies, procedures, and competition requirements as necessary to ensure fair play, competitive integrity, participant safety, and the effective administration of league operations.

Rule changes may become effective immediately upon approval by IEN when deemed necessary to address unforeseen circumstances, publisher requirements, technical issues, eligibility concerns, competitive balance, or other matters affecting league operations.

IEN will make reasonable efforts to communicate significant rule changes to affected participants; however, failure to provide notice shall not invalidate any rule interpretation, decision, or amendment made by IEN. All decisions made by IEN regarding the application and enforcement of league rules are final unless otherwise determined by the IEN Board of Directors.

Changelog

May 2024

- Addition of varsity payment
- Competition council removed
- Definitions updated
 - Tournament changed to Solo
 - Removal of Academy
- Chess rules updated
- Fortnite Battle Royale updated
- Minecraft updated
- SSBU rules updated
 - Changed from Best of 2 to Best of 3
 - Stage of the Week removed from counterpicks
 - Kalos Pokemon League added to counterpicks
- Tetris rules updated
- Fortnite Zone Wars added
- Mario Kart 8 Deluxe added
- Updated Board of Directors
- Updated Confidentiality
- Updated Liability

January 2025

- Updated Valorant map pool (patch 10.00)
- CompMC cost increase to \$35.00

August 2025

- Added clarification about game platforms for IEN in-person events
- Removed title rules section
- Linked individual title rules docs
- Added Marvel Rivals
- Updated Valorant map pool (again)
- Updated Overwatch 2 map rotation
- Changed Mario Kart map selection/ pool
- Changed Fortnite game mods and map codes to reflect new custom maps
- Updated format for chess and Tetris playoffs
- Updated iRacing rules

- Readded Stage of the Week to SSBU Counterpick stage list.

September 2024

- Updated Fortnite Zone Wars map code, scoring information and rules
- Updated Valorant Map Pool

November 2025

- Added character restrictions for new and reworked characters (Valorant, Overwatch, Marvel Rivals).
- Added clarification about role swapping to Overwatch rules.

January 2026

- Updated Valorant competitive map pool to reflect the update coming on January 7th.
- Changed chess playoffs to Bo3 for semifinals. (Still Bo5 for finals & 3rd place)

February 2026

- Changed League of Legends streaming requirements to 3-minute delay in reflection of removal of client-enforced delay.

August 2026

- Updated Rules to clarify existing policies and procedures.
- Added bench player
- Added rule about 1st year team
- Changed number of subs per team to $\frac{1}{2}$ of starters rounded up
- Changed 1st official warning
- Changed how divisions of school work
- Changed must have at least 1 sub per varsity team
- Changed Club+ to Tournament
- Added Roster Locks
- Updated IEN Official Communications
- Updated rescheduling matches
- Updated Outside Coach Communications

